

Lily Botha

☎ (404) 989-2853 | ✉ bothlg22@wfu.edu | 🌐 Github

Research Interests

Impact of trauma on memory; Post-traumatic stress disorder (PTSD), Military and veteran mental health; Psychedelic-assisted therapy

Education

Wake Forest University

BACHELOR OF ARTS IN PSYCHOLOGY

- GPA: 3.69 | Dean's List

Winston-Salem, NC

Expected May 2026

Danish Institute for Study Abroad (DIS)

Copenhagen, Denmark

Fall 2024

- Coursework in well-being psychology and the cognitive psychology of decision-making.

Research Experience

Research Assistant

Emotional Adaptation &
Psychophysiology Lab, Wake Forest
University (PI: Christian Waugh, PhD)

Summer 2025 – Present

- Cleaned, analyzed, and visualized behavioral and survey data in R, Excel, and Qualtrics for reinforcement-learning and emotional reappraisal studies; developed custom R scripts to reconstruct missing log-file data; designed experimental stimuli in Photoshop and trained research assistants; administered affective working-memory protocols and maintained participant tracking logs.

Research Assistant

Growth Initiative Lab, Wake Forest
University (PI: Eranda
Jayawickreme, PhD)

Spring 2024 – Present

- Screened interview transcripts and coded themes for a study on pluralism in Sri Lanka; screened 5,900 articles for a meta-synthesis on post-traumatic growth; applied inclusion/exclusion criteria and maintained structured coding logs.

Research Assistant

School of Law, Wake Forest
University (PI: Gregory Parks, JD,
PhD)

Summer 2025 – Fall 2025

- Conducted systematic literature reviews on fraternities, race, and law; co-authored research memos synthesizing findings on bystander intervention and group cohesion.

Relevant Professional Experience

Tutor

Student-Athlete Services, Wake
Forest University
Fall 2025 – Present

- Provided one-on-one philosophy tutoring; supported study strategies, time management, and academic progress monitoring.

Swim Instructor

Wake Forest University & Life Time
Inc.

Spring 2021 – Present

- Designed individualized lesson plans; coached youth swim teams and coordinated meets; delivered adaptive instruction for individuals with autism, Down syndrome, cerebral palsy, and behavioral disabilities.

Lifeguard

Wake Forest University & Life Time
Inc.

Spring 2020 – Present

- Responded to emergencies and maintained safety protocols; provided professional customer service.

- Supervised and trained 40+ lifeguards and instructors; coordinated scheduling and daily operations.

Awards and Grants

Understanding Takeover Performance in Urgent Situations during Level-3 Driving	2025
UMTRI & MCITY INTEGRATION FUND, UNIVERSITY OF MICHIGAN	\$99,971
Role: PI	

AS POSTDOC

Probing Attentional Allocation with a Novel Forced-Response Method	2023
STANDARD GRANT, NATIONAL SCIENCE FOUNDATION	\$659,877
Role: Key Personnel (Postdoc)	
Investigating Interference-Control in ADHD Using a Novel Forced-Response Method	2023
R21, NATIONAL INSTITUTE OF MENTAL HEALTH	\$429,000
Role: Key Personnel (Postdoc)	

AS GRADUATE STUDENT

Stanley E. and Ruth B. Dimond Best Dissertation Award	2020
SCHOOL OF EDUCATION, UNIVERSITY OF MICHIGAN	\$500
Dissertation: Mind-wandering: What Can We Learn from Eye Movements?	
MPA Graduate Student Paper Award	2020
MIDWESTERN PSYCHOLOGICAL ASSOCIATION ANNUAL MEETING	\$300
Scan-paths of mind-wandering during real-world scene perception	
ProQuest Distinguished Dissertation Award (Nomination)	2020
SCHOOL OF EDUCATION, UNIVERSITY OF MICHIGAN	
Rackham One-Term Dissertation Fellowship	2019
RACKHAM GRADUATE SCHOOL, UNIVERSITY OF MICHIGAN	\$17417
Rackham Graduate Student Research Grant	2019
RACKHAM GRADUATE SCHOOL, UNIVERSITY OF MICHIGAN	\$3000
Rackham Conference Travel Grant	2019, 2018, 2017
RACKHAM GRADUATE SCHOOL, UNIVERSITY OF MICHIGAN	\$1050
Rackham Summer Training Award	2018
RACKHAM GRADUATE SCHOOL, UNIVERSITY OF MICHIGAN	\$3700
Professor & Mrs. Cho-Yee To Travel Grant	2017, 2015
SCHOOL OF EDUCATION, UNIVERSITY OF MICHIGAN	\$500

AS UNDERGRADUATE STUDENT

China National Scholarship	2014
MINISTRY OF EDUCATION OF THE PEOPLE’S REPUBLIC OF CHINA	\$1500
The First Rank Academic Scholarship	2014, 2013
FACULTY OF PSYCHOLOGY, BEIJING NORMAL UNIVERSITY	\$300
Beijing Student Research and Entrepreneurial Action Plan	2013
BEIJING MUNICIPAL COMMISSION OF EDUCATION	\$1500
Undergraduate Student Research Grant	2012
FACULTY OF PSYCHOLOGY, BEIJING NORMAL UNIVERSITY	\$280

Teaching and Mentoring Experience

References

John Jonides, Ph.D.

EDWARD E. SMITH PROFESSOR OF PSYCHOLOGY AND NEUROSCIENCE; CO-DIRECTOR, FUNCTIONAL MRI CENTER, UNIVERSITY OF MICHIGAN

jjonides@umich.edu

Taraz G. Lee, Ph.D.

ASSISTANT PROFESSOR OF PSYCHOLOGY, UNIVERSITY OF MICHIGAN

tarazlee@umich.edu

Priti Shah, Ph.D.

DEPARTMENT CHAIR, ARTHUR THURNAU PROFESSOR OF PSYCHOLOGY, EDUCATION, AND INFORMATION, UNIVERSITY OF MICHIGAN

priti@umich.edu

Kevin F. Miller, Ph.D.

PROFESSOR OF PSYCHOLOGY AND EDUCATION, UNIVERSITY OF MICHIGAN

kevinmil@umich.edu